

Topic: Definition, nature and scope of Sociology

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What is Sociology?

- The term “Sociology” derived from the latin word ‘Socius’ (companion) and the Greek word ‘Logos’ (study of). Thus, etymological meaning of sociology is ‘the science of society’.
- Sociology is the scientific study of human society and social behavior.
- Emile Durkheim says, “ Sociology is the science of institutions.”
- Kovalevsky says, “ Sociology is the science of social organization and social change.”
- Max Weber says, “ Sociology is the study of social action.”
- MacIver and page said that “ Sociology alone studies social relationships themselves and society itself.”
- “Sociology is the scientific study of human social life, groups and societies” (Giddens, Sociology, 2006:4).
- So, finally we can say that Sociology is a discipline in social sciences concerned with the human society and human activities. It is one of the youngest social sciences.

Nature of Sociology

- ❖ Sociology is an independent science.
- ❖ Sociology is a social science not a physical science.
- ❖ Sociology is relatively an abstract science not a concrete science.
- ❖ Sociology is science of interrelationship.
- ❖ It has its own perspective.
- ❖ Sociology is the study of whole society.
- ❖ Sociology is the science of social structure.
- ❖ Sociology is a value free science.
- ❖ Sociology is science of causal explanation of facts.
- ❖ Sociology as science of statics and dynamics.
- ❖ Sociology as a science of social class and social stratification.
- ❖ Sociology as science of scientific method.
- ❖ Sociology as science of social problems.
- ❖ Sociology as science of social change.

Scope of sociology

- ❖ Sociological theories
- ❖ Historical sociology-by Marx
 - Primitive communism
 - Slavery
 - Feudalistic society
 - Capitalistic society
 - Socialistic society
 - Modern communism
- ❖ Sociology of family and marriage
- ❖ Social demography
- ❖ Rural and urban sociology
- ❖ Sociology of religion
- ❖ Sociology of education
- ❖ Political sociology
- ❖ Sociology of law
- ❖ Social psychology
- ❖ Cultural sociology
- ❖ Industrial sociology
- ❖ Medical sociology

Scope of sociology (continue)

- ❖ Environmental sociology
- ❖ Gender and society
- ❖ Criminology
- ❖ Social inequality and social stratification
- ❖ Social thought
- ❖ Social statistics
- ❖ Sociological problem and social disorganization
- ❖ Sociology of art
- ❖ Folk sociology
- ❖ Sociology of war
- ❖ Sociology of mass communication etc.

List of Books

Serial no	Name of the Book	Author
1.	Introductory Sociology Or Somajbiggan Poriciti	Habibur Rahman
2.	Higher Secondary Sociology book First paper	Anwarullah Chowdhury and Habibur Rahman
3.	Introduction to Sociology	Zerihun Doda
4.	Sociology (Fifth edition)	Anthony Giddens